

[backup.sh](#)

```
#!/bin/bash
<< readme
This is a script for backup with 3 day rotation
Usage:
./backup.sh ./backup.sh /root/datafile /root/backup
readme
function display_usage {
echo "Usage: ./backup.sh /root/datafile /root/backup"
}
if [ $# -eq 0 ]; then
display_usage
fi
source_dir=$1
timestamp=$(date '+%Y-%m-%d-%H-%M-%S')
backup_dir=$2
function create_backup {
zip -r "${backup_dir}/backup_${timestamp}.zip" "${source_dir}" > /dev/null
if [ $? -eq 0 ]; then
echo "backup generated successfully for ${timestamp}"
fi
}
function perform_rotation {
backups=$(ls -t "${backup_dir}/backup_*.zip 2>/dev/null)
if [ "${#backups[@]}" -gt 3 ]; then
echo "Performing rotation for 3 days"
backups_to_remove="${backups[@]:3}"
for backup in "${backups_to_remove[@]}"
do
rm -f ${backup}
done
fi
}
create_backup
perform_rotation
```

```
ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~$ ./backup.sh /home/ubuntu/source /home/ubuntu/backups
backup generated successfully for 2026-06-06-12-58-00
ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~$ cd backups
ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~/backups$ ls
backup_2026-06-06-12-58-00.zip
ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~/backups$
```

```
ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~/backups$ ls
backup.sh  backup_2026-06-06-13-02-18.zip  backup_2026-06-06-13-02-23.zip  backup_2026-06-06-13-02-25.zip
ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~/backups$
```

To schedule `backup.sh` every **3 minutes** using cron:

1. Open crontab

None

```
crontab -e
```

```
ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~/backups$ crontab -e
no crontab for ubuntu - using an empty one
Select an editor. To change later, run select-editor again.
 1. /bin/nano      <---- easiest
 2. /usr/bin/vim.basic
 3. /usr/bin/vim.tiny
 4. /bin/ed

Choose 1-4 [1]: 1
crontab: installing new crontab
ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~/backups$
```

2. Add this line

None

```
*/3 * * * * /home/ubuntu/backup.sh /home/ubuntu/source
/home/ubuntu/backups
```

```
GNU nano 8.7.1 /tmp/crontab.6LJWtM/crontab
# Edit this file to introduce tasks to be run by cron.
#
# Each task to run has to be defined through a single line
# indicating with different fields when the task will be run
# and what command to run for the task
#
# To define the time you can provide concrete values for
# minute (m), hour (h), day of month (dom), month (mon),
# and day of week (dow) or use '*' in these fields (for 'any').
#
# Notice that tasks will be started based on the cron's system
# daemon's notion of time and timezones.
#
# Output of the crontab jobs (including errors) is sent through
# email to the user the crontab file belongs to (unless redirected).
#
# For example, you can run a backup of all your user accounts
# at 5 a.m every week with:
# 0 5 * * * tar -czf /var/backups/home.tgz /home/
#
# For more information see the manual pages of crontab(5) and cron(8)
#
# m h dom mon dow   command
*/3 * * * * /home/ubuntu/backup.sh /home/ubuntu/source /home/ubuntu/backups
```

Cron format

None

```
┌────────── Minute (0-59)
| ┌──────── Hour (0-23)
| | ┌────── Day of Month (1-31)
| | | ┌──── Month (1-12)
| | | | ┌── Day of Week (0-7)
| | | | |
| | | | |
*/3 * * * * command
```

`*/3` means **every 3 minutes**.

3. Make the script executable

None

```
chmod +x /home/ubuntu/backup.sh
```

4. Verify the cron job

None

```
crontab -l
```

Expected output:

None

```
*/3 * * * * /home/ubuntu/backup.sh /home/ubuntu/source
/home/ubuntu/backups
```

5. Check if backups are being created

After a few minutes:

None

```
ls -lh /home/ubuntu/backups
```

```

ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~/backups$ crontab -l
# Edit this file to introduce tasks to be run by cron.
#
# Each task to run has to be defined through a single line
# indicating with different fields when the task will be run
# and what command to run for the task
#
# To define the time you can provide concrete values for
# minute (m), hour (h), day of month (dom), month (mon),
# and day of week (dow) or use '*' in these fields (for 'any').
#
# Notice that tasks will be started based on the cron's system
# daemon's notion of time and timezones.
#
# Output of the crontab jobs (including errors) is sent through
# email to the user the crontab file belongs to (unless redirected).
#
# For example, you can run a backup of all your user accounts
# at 5 a.m every week with:
# 0 5 * * 1 tar -zcf /var/backups/home.tgz /home/
#
# For more information see the manual pages of crontab(5) and cron(8)
#
# m h dom mon dow   command
*/3 * * * * /home/ubuntu/backup.sh /home/ubuntu/source /home/ubuntu/backups
ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~/backups$ █

```

You should see files like:

```

ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~/backups$ ls
backup.sh  backup_2026-06-06-13-02-18.zip  backup_2026-06-06-13-02-23.zip  backup_2026-06-06-13-02-25.zip
ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~/backups$ ls
backup.sh  backup_2026-06-06-13-02-23.zip  backup_2026-06-06-13-02-25.zip  backup_2026-06-06-13-09-01.zip
ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~/backups$ ls
backup.sh  backup_2026-06-06-13-02-23.zip  backup_2026-06-06-13-02-25.zip  backup_2026-06-06-13-09-01.zip
ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~/backups$ ls
backup.sh  backup_2026-06-06-13-02-25.zip  backup_2026-06-06-13-09-01.zip  backup_2026-06-06-13-12-01.zip
ubuntu@ip-172-31-24-64:~/backups$ █

```